

Transfer and Printing

9.1 USB and Firewire

The most common method of transferring digital images from a camera to the PC, or for that matter, to any storage device is via USB. Most of us are familiar with USB; but for the uninitiated, here is a quick primer. USB stands for Universal Serial Bus, and is an industry standard used to interface devices with a host computer. It functions via standardised interface sockets. While there are several receptacle types within USB, the Series A and B are the most commonly used. Most digital cameras, however, use Micro and Mini receptacles that are part of the USB 2.0 standard.

You can transfer digital images to a computer via a USB cable, either directly from the camera or using an external card reader. To transfer images, connect your camera to the PC via a USB cable. Once the connection is setup, turn on the camera. It should go to transfer mode by default. Most cameras come with some sort of editing / picture management software that you need to install. If such a picture management application is not installed on the system, the camera is detected as an external storage device. After this, it's a simple matter of copying files like any other flash drive. There are also some proprietary docks that are essentially USB devices meant for



Types of connectors (l to r) Mini-B plug, B-type plug, A-type receptacle, A-type plug